

Lesson 10

REVISION 02: LESSON 06 - 09



Warm-Up

Match each scenario with the correct language phrases:

Scenarios

1. You are explaining a technical IT concept to a colleague from a different department who may not understand jargon.
2. You are summarizing an idea in the simplest terms to ensure your team understands it before making decisions.
3. You are trying to help others visualize how a process works by using relatable comparisons and examples.
4. You are wrapping up a discussion and want to make sure everyone is on the same page.

Phrases

- a. “To put it simply, ...”
- b. “Would you like me to explain more?”
- c. “It means ...”
- d. “For example, ...”



Practice

Group Discussion

Work in pairs or small groups to discuss and review the following topics:

1. **Workplace Communication:** Reflect on a cross-functional communication breakdown. How would you resolve it using active listening and clarity strategies?
 - *What caused the communication breakdown in this situation?*
 - *What specific actions could each team member take to improve clarity?*
 - *How can active listening prevent misunderstandings in cross-functional teams?*

2. **Cross-Cultural Meeting:** You're in a cross-cultural meeting with misunderstandings between team members. How would you use cultural understanding to find common ground?
 - *What misunderstandings might arise in a cross-cultural meeting, such as differences in politeness, directness, or priorities?*
 - *What are some diplomatic phrases or strategies you could use to remain neutral? (e.g. "From my cultural perspective..."; "Let's find common ground.")*
 - *How would you show cultural empathy to acknowledge diverse team members' viewpoints?*
3. **Chairing a Meeting:** As a meeting chairperson, what techniques would you use to keep discussions structured, inclusive, and on time?
 - *How would you open the meeting and explain the agenda clearly?*
 - *What would you do if one person dominated the conversation? How could you invite quieter participants to share their thoughts?*
 - *What would you do to reinforce time management during the meeting?*



Production

ROLE-PLAY: CHAIR A MEETING

Context: Your team is tasked with deciding how to allocate a \$100,000 budget for Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives. The goal is to reach a consensus on how to divide the funds across three priorities:

- **Environmental sustainability** (e.g., reducing carbon footprint).
- **Community education programs** (e.g., skills training for local youth).
- **Disaster relief efforts** (e.g., aid for natural disasters).

Step 1: Choose a Role:

Before the meeting, review the descriptions and phrases for the host styles. Prepare to adapt your communication style to match the role you're assigned.

	Approach	Examples
Host A	- Direct, task-focused, and goal-driven. - Prioritize efficiency and clear decision-making	- <i>“Let’s dive right in. What’s your top priority, and why?”</i> - <i>“Great point—let’s build on that to move forward.”</i>
Host B	- Polite, reserved, and consensus-driven. - Avoid direct confrontation and prioritize maintaining harmony. - Express disagreement subtly and consider long-term implications.	- <i>“Would anyone else like to share their thoughts before we move forward?”</i>
Host C	- Relationship-oriented and mindful of hierarchy. - Balance politeness with firmness and prefer collaborative communication that respects group harmony.	- <i>“I appreciate all of your perspectives. Let’s evaluate the long-term impacts of each idea.”</i>

Step 2: Chair the Meeting:

Work in small groups. Each person will take on one host role (A, B or C) and take turns chairing the meeting. While hosting, use cultural communication strategies appropriate for your role (e.g., direct vs. reserved, or relationship vs. task-focused).

Step 3: Conclude the Meeting:

Once everyone has had a turn hosting, work together to finalize how the \$100,000 budget will be divided. Make sure all voices are heard, and the decision reflects effective collaboration.

Discussion:

- What were the differences in communication styles between each host?
- Which host approach was easier to adapt to? Which was more challenging? Why?
- Did cultural differences influence the group dynamics or decision-making? How?
- What strategies helped the most in reaching a collaborative decision?